AI EVERY TIME · CHEAT SHEET

# Claude Skills Starter Kit

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from the guide in Guides

## 1 WHAT A SKILL IS

A folder that teaches Claude one job your way: a `SKILL.md` file with a **name**, a **description** and instructions, plus any templates or scripts.

Claude always sees each skill's name and description; it reads the instructions only when a request needs them, and the extra files only if they're needed.

## 2 INSTALL IT IN CLAUDE

1. Download the skill's **.zip**. Keep it zipped.
2. **Settings → Capabilities**: turn on **Code execution and file creation** (*Create and edit files* in the newer layout).
3. **Customize → Skills → + → Create skill → Upload a skill**, then choose the zip.
4. Switch the skill on.

Enterprise: an owner turns skills on first, in **Organization settings → Plugins & skills → Policy**.

## 3 USE IT

- Just ask: Claude picks a skill when your request matches its description.
- To be sure, name it: "Use my analyze-data skill to..."
- In Claude Code and the Excel, PowerPoint, Word and Outlook add-ins, type `/` and pick one.
- Not used? Check its switch is on, name it, or sharpen its description.

## 4 IN CLAUDE CODE

- All projects: unzip into `~/.claude/skills/`
- One project: unzip into `.claude/skills/` and commit it.
- Run one with `/skill-name`; `/skills` lists them.
- Skills switched on in your Claude account sync when you sign in with it.

## 5 THE TEN SKILLS IN THIS KIT

| SKILL | WHAT IT DOES | TRY ASKING |
|---|---|---|
| **`/clarify-first`** | One question at a time until the task is clear, then a brief | *"A website for my bakery."* |
| **`/brief-builder`** | Turns a brain dump or call notes into a task brief | *"Make these notes a brief."* |
| **`/natural-voice`** | Makes a draft read like a person wrote it; keeps every fact | *"Make this sound like me."* |
| **`/persuasive-copy`** | Headlines, landing pages, emails and ads, plus variants to test | *"A landing page for my course."* |
| **`/co-write`** | Long documents with you, from outline to final read-through | *"Help me write a proposal."* |
| **`/plain-technical-english`** | Simplified Technical English rewrite, checked by a script | *"Rewrite these set-up steps."* |
| **`/session-handoff`** | A one-page handoff note, so a new chat can carry on | *"Write a handoff."* |
| **`/idea-to-website`** | Plan, design, build, GitHub, deploy: idea to a live site | *"A one-page photo site."* |
| **`/analyze-data`** | Answers data questions; checks joins, duplicates, definitions | *"What drove Q3 revenue?"* |
| **`/skill-maker`** | Makes, checks and zips a new skill with you | *"Make my weekly report a skill."* |

## 6 MAKE YOUR OWN

```
weekly-report/
├─ SKILL.md name, description, steps
├─ reference.md detail read when needed
├─ templates/ files to fill in
└─ scripts/ steps that must be exact
```

**Test it** with three requests that should use it and two that shouldn't. If Claude misses one, improve the description first.

## 7 THE RULES

- **name**: lowercase letters, numbers, hyphens; 64 characters at most; no "claude" or "anthropic"; same as the folder.
- **description**: what it does **and** when to use it, in the third person; 200 characters at most in the Claude apps.
- **instructions**: under 500 lines; steps, rules, an example, a checklist.
- **zip the folder**, so the zip holds `weekly-report/SKILL.md`.

## ! BEFORE YOU SWITCH A SKILL ON

Skills can run code. Install them only from sources you trust, and read every file first, especially scripts and anything that downloads software or sends data to a website. Never put passwords, API keys or personal data in a skill.



How skills work: Anthropic's documentation, October 2026